STEVEN JACOBS

Raleigh, NC

(248) 904-6933

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EXPERTISE

Microsoft Power Platform

Microsoft Fabric

Workflow Optimization

Reporting & Analytical Tools

Power BI / Tableau

Power Automate

Power Apps

Process Improvement

Azure SQL

Azure Data Factory

Azure Functions

REST APIs

ETL & Data Warehousing

EDUCATION

MBA
University of Michigan
1992 – 1995

MASTER OF ARCHITECTURE
University of Michigan
1992 – 1995

BACHELOR'S DEGREE
Lawrence Tech. University
1992

PROFILE

I'm a data engineering and Power Platform architect with 12+ years of experience designing end-to-end systems that turn raw data into reliable, actionable intelligence. My background spans BI leadership, cloud architecture, and low-code engineering, giving me a unique ability to build both the data foundations and the user-facing experiences that sit on top of them.

I work across Microsoft Fabric, Azure Data Factory, SQL, Power BI, Power Apps, and Power Automate to create scalable pipelines, semantic models, and automated workflows. One of my favorite projects was architecting a middleware solution that processed more than 1.8 million webhook events annually, enabling real-time automation and cross-platform reporting.

Whether I'm building a data pipeline, mentoring a team member, or presenting insights to senior leadership, my goal is the same: turn data into decisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE ARCHITECT
CBRE, Inc. | 2018 – 2025

Managed and mentored a cross-functional team of BI professionals, including solutions developers, Power BI dashboard designers, and database managers, fostering a high-performance, collaborative culture.

- Led and mentored a cross-functional BI engineering team, fostering a collaborative, high-performance culture focused on scalable delivery.
- Introduced and championed Microsoft Power Platform capabilities (Power BI, Power Apps, Power Automate), expanding the team's automation, reporting, and app-development maturity.
- Architected and deployed a middleware integration platform using Azure Functions, REST APIs, and webhook ingestion, enabling real-time data exchange across SaaS systems and processing 1.8M+ automated triggers annually.
- Developed scalable ETL pipelines using Azure Data Factory, Power Automate, and Azure Data Lake Gen2, feeding a centralized Azure SQL data warehouse.

TECHNICAL SOLUTIONS LEAD
CBRE, Inc. | 2015 - 2018

During this role, I became the go-to technical resource for our team, identifying opportunities to streamline operations through automation, data integration, and custom tooling.

- Developed custom applications using Microsoft Access, SharePoint, and VBA, integrating Excel and Outlook to automate workflows.
- Served as the de facto technical lead, building and maintaining internal tools to support project tracking, reporting, and communication.
- Partnered with account leadership to identify process-improvement opportunities and implement data-driven solutions that increased efficiency and reduced operational friction

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

SENIOR PROJECT MANAGER
CBRE, Inc. | 2012 – 2015

Oversaw a high-volume portfolio of quick-turn, small-scale projects and led a team of project managers.

Played a key role in the transition from a legacy, paper- and email-based system to a modern SaaS platform, significantly improving the team's ability to manage high-volume work efficiently. Trained employees, clients, and vendors on the new technology and quickly became a liaison to the SaaS development team, contributing to the enhancement of reporting capabilities and refinement of custom features.

PROJECT MANAGER
Salzeider, Inc. | 2007 - 2012

Managed all aspects of commercial construction projects, with a focus on quality delivery, client satisfaction, and operational efficiency, including project budgets, cost tracking, and financial reporting to ensure profitability and transparency.

RELATED EXPERIENCE

Member of Microsoft's Power Customer Advisory Team, an invitation-only group of Power Platform super-users who are asked to provide feedback on unreleased features and updates. I was invited to present at a recent Microsoft Business Applications Summit annual conference, demonstrating my use of automation tools used for process improvement.

Volunteered my data-analytical skills to a local food pantry, creating dashboards used to help understand their client dataset. I revealed trends over time, showing the changing needs of clients by household income and geography

PERSONAL INSPIRATION

The following are key mentors who have significantly shaped my career aspirations and professional development

The writings of Nate Silver, statistician, author and founder of FiveThirtyEight enlightened me to the power of storytelling through data visualization.

The writings of Richard Thaler, Nobel laureate and one of the founders of behavioral economics, significantly shaped my perspective on how to design and implement effective solutions for audiences whom I shall never meet.

John Chi, Certified Six Sigma Black Belt and author of *Sometimes the Juice is Just Not Worth the Squeeze*, changed the trajectory of my career with his mentorship and inspirational guidance.